The Life You *Choose*

FREE EXERCISE · FROM STEP 1 OF THE MADE REAL BLUEPRINT

# An ordinary *Tuesday*.

Imagine an ordinary Tuesday in the life you want, including work, chores and downtime. Take a pen and a quiet moment.

WARM-UP

## Moments that felt good

Think of one or two moments from the last few years when you felt content, engaged or proud. Choose at least one from an ordinary day. Where were you? What were you doing? Who was with you? What made it possible?

## A normal day in the life you want

*Now you turn those ingredients into a day.*

We use an ordinary day because that is what most of your life will be. It can feel less exciting than imagining a big change, but it gives you a useful question: would I enjoy the everyday life that comes with it?

An ordinary day also gives you something to test. You can visit a place, or change one day of your week where you live, and try living a normal Tuesday. It is much harder to test a word like "happiness".

**How much detail?** Enough that someone else could film it. Look at the difference:

| Too vague to plan | Detailed enough to plan |
|---|---|
| "A house with a view" | "Coffee on the terrace, looking at olive trees, before anyone else is awake" |
| "Meaningful work" | "Two mornings a week helping new business owners solve problems I understand" |
| "Close to family" | "My sister can come for dinner without booking a flight" |

The detail in the right-hand column gives you something you can check against a real house, job or town.

NOW YOU

Describe this day from morning to evening. Include an ordinary detail you would not put in a holiday brochure: housework, rain, or an hour when nothing much happens. Use these questions to help you:

- Where do you wake up? What do you see from your window?
- What do you do in the morning? And in the afternoon?
- What is your work, or how do you spend your time?
- Who is with you? How does the day end?

> **Made-up example (Maria, 46):** I wake up at 7, without an alarm. From my window, I see olive trees. I drink coffee outside. In the morning, I work online for my clients for four hours. In the afternoon, I work in the garden or go to the market in the village. My partner and I cook together. Twice a week, friends come for dinner. Two afternoons a week are for paperwork and cleaning, and I don't enjoy them. I go to bed tired, but happy.

THE NEED BEHIND THE PICTURE

Olive trees might mean calm, nature or space. What are the two or three needs behind your normal day?

GO DEEPER (OPTIONAL)

Read your day again and underline the concrete details: coffee, terrace, olive trees, clients, sister. If there are only a few, add enough detail for someone else to picture the day as clearly as you do.

Then add the less enjoyable parts: housework, paid work, a day when you feel tired, a rainy winter week, time alone. Does the picture still feel good? Could you meet the same needs another way, including closer to home?

**Make it visible.** Collect five to eight photos of ordinary scenes that fit your day: a kitchen table, a path, a workshop, a market. Use your own photos where you can. Under each one, write the need it represents. These pictures will help you compare real places with the daily life you want.

> Some ideas may come from lives you have seen online. Write them down too. Later, you can ask which parts actually matter to you.

## What comes next

This exercise is one part of Step 1, Picture. In the full step, you look at your life as it is now, make an initial budget and compare your options. You finish with a direction to explore and test.

Phase 1 of The Made Real Blueprint (Steps 1 to 3) is available now, with workbooks and an app. See the options at **maderealblueprint.com**.

Questions, or want to tell me about your Tuesday? Send me a message on **WhatsApp** or email **info@maderealblueprint.com**. Mwata

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